

Scientific Use File
SOEP-RV VSKT 2022

SOEPRV

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The Scientific Use File "SOEP-RV VSKT 2022" and the corresponding code plan are developed and updated in the departments 0642 and 0512 of the Research Data Centre of the German Pension Insurance (FDZ-RV).

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SOEP-RV VSKT 2022

Administrative data in the format of a scientific use file of the 2022 sample of insured accounts (*Versichertenkontenstichprobe*, VSKT) – an expansion of the SOEP data

For 16,583 respondents (as of January 2025) of the SOEP study, the SOEP-RV.VSKT.2022 dataset expands on the available survey data by linking to statistical data from the insurance account with the German pension insurance scheme (*Deutsche Rentenversicherung*, DRV). The research data from the accounts of the pension insurance scheme correspond to the formats of the data reports in the statistical reporting of the pension insurance scheme, namely the sample of pensions (*Rentenbestand*, RTBN), the sample of insured accounts (*Versichertenkontenstichprobe*, VSKT) and the pension rights adjustment statistics (*Versorgungsausgleichsstatistik*, VA).

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1. General information about the dataset

The aim of the dataset is to enable researchers to gain meaningful insights into the insurance biography of the survey respondents. Although biographic information is available in the SOEP from the age of 14 from the biographical questionnaire, this information does not permit an analysis of intra-year changes nor does it include income data, for example, prior to participation in the survey. Combining the survey data of the SOEP with the information from the biography of insured persons of the German pension insurance scheme allows these gaps to be closed.

The biography of insured persons contains extensive details about the insured persons. For data protection reasons, data has therefore been capped¹, rounded² and condensed³ in some cases. Moreover, the pension-relevant circumstances (e.g. status of dependent employment) have been grouped into events that reflect the status of the respondents in the pension insurance scheme. A range of variables has thus been constructed, which are not contained in this form in the original statistical data. A precise explanation of how these variables were generated and named can be found in Table 2 in the Appendix.

The SUF SOEP-RV.VSKT.2022 comprises two datasets: a cross-sectional dataset, the so-called “fixed part” and a longitudinal dataset, the so-called “variable part”.

In addition to data-technical and sociodemographic characteristics as well as values from the pension calculation, the fixed part contains sums from biographical history characteristics as at the reference date at the end of the reporting year as well as characteristics on pension rights adjustment in the event of divorce. The variables of the sums from the history characteristics are stated as cumulative “lifetime” values in the fixed part, i.e. as the respective sums of all events recorded in the pension account from the biography calendar.⁴ These history characteristics (with few exceptions) are also found in the variable part, with the respective reference period with values for the year and month. Adding together the respective statuses of the variable section yields the cumulative values of the fixed part (as a general rule). Negative deviations may arise in individual cases because not all parallel statuses are shown in the variable part.

The variable part comes in “long long”⁵ format; this means it contains an entry for each month of the biography calendar for each person. Besides the date variables, the dataset contains information on up to five parallel, pension-relevant statuses. For each of these statuses, information is recorded on its type, the number of days entered with the status in the respective month and the corresponding earning points. The period earnings (ZREG) are also shown in STATUS_1. These are the gross earnings recognized in the account in the respective period. The status variables are explained in the following.

Periods of employment are always recorded in STATUS_1, together with the gross earnings (ZREG) and the earning points (EGTP) for the pension calculation. STATUS_1 contains both employment subject to social insurance contributions as well as self-employment recorded in the pension account and permits

¹ In the fixed part, the supplements and reductions from the pension rights adjustment have been capped at a value of 30 earning points.

² In the variable part of the SUF SOEP-RV.VSKT, the period earnings (ZREG) are only offered in integers and the earning points (EGTP) are rounded to three decimal places.

³ While daily values exist for pension-relevant circumstances in the pension insurance accounts, the daily values are aggregated to monthly values in the variable part.

⁴ January of the year in which the person reaches the age of 14 until December of the current reporting year

⁵ Information on data management can be found in Chapter 3 of this document.

a distinction between employment in western or eastern Germany. Moreover, employment in the mining sector (*Knappschaft*) is shown separately. In the event of parallel employment activities, the employment with the highest “daily” gross earnings is always shown in STATUS_1; the cumulative gross earnings from all other parallel gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) or self-employment (variable NJB) are then shown in STATUS_2 or STATUS_3. Parallel employment activities are only considered in STATUS_2 or STATUS_3 if the earning points obtained therefrom are higher than the other parallel statuses. The prioritization concept is explained in detail further below. An overview of all 28 possible statuses is provided by Table 2 on the following page.

Periods with marginal employment (GF0 and GF1) are likewise always shown in the variable part. Here, a distinction is possible between periods without an insurance obligation (STATUS_4) and periods with an insurance obligation (STATUS_5). Since no earning points (EGPT) are booked for employment without an insurance obligation, the variable “STATUS_4_EGPT” is omitted.

While the variables on employment subject to social insurance contributions and self-employment (STATUS_1) and on marginal employment (STATUS_4 and STATUS_5) are always recorded in the variable part, all other possible statuses (see Table 2) compete for inclusion in STATUS_2 or STATUS_3.⁶ The categories in Table 2 include all relevant statuses under social insurance law.

Table 1

STATUS_1	STATUS_1_TAGE	STATUS_1_ZREG	STATUS_1_EGPT	STATUS_2	STATUS_2_TAGE	STATUS_2_EGPT	STATUS_3	STATUS_3_TAGE	STATUS_3_EGPT	STATUS_4	STATUS_5	STATUS_5_EGPT
WSB	14	637	.022	ALG	12	.015	AUF	5	.006	31	.	.

Table 1 presents an example of a month for a person in the variable part of the dataset. During this month, the person was gainfully employed and subject to social insurance contributions for 14 days (STATUS_1_TAGE) in western Germany (“WSB” in STATUS_1) and received a monthly pay in the amount of 637 euros (STATUS_1_ZREG). Consequently, 0.022 earning points were credited in the pension account (STATUS_1_EGPT). In addition, 12 days (STATUS_2_TAGE) were recorded with unemployment (“ALG” in STATUS_2) and 5 days (STATUS_3_TAGE) with incapacity to work (“AUF” in STATUS_3) in the account in this month. For the whole month (31 days), the person was marginally employed and thus exempt from the insurance obligation (STATUS_4_TAGE).

If the person had received more than 0.006 EGPT this month for another pension-relevant status, the periods of incapacity to work would have been omitted from the dataset in favor of this status. This occurs for only 0.33% of the episodes in the entire dataset.

⁶ For data protection reasons, no more than two additional statuses (besides the employment variables in STATUS_1, STATUS_4 and STATUS_5) can be included. The highest obtained earning points per day applies for prioritisation. In the event of equal earning points, the statistical order is prioritised as shown in Table 2.

Table 2 Possible values of the statuses

STATUS_1	WSB	gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) - west
	WKN	miner's employment - west
	WSS	compulsory self-employment contribution - west
	OSB	gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) - east since 7/1990
	OKN	miner's employment - east
	OSS	compulsory self-employment contribution - east
	DDR OSB	gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) - east until 6/1990
	DDR OKN	miner's employment - east until 6/1990
	ATZ WSB	part-time employment prior to retirement in the jurisdiction WSB
	ATZ OSB	part-time employment prior to retirement in the jurisdiction OSB
	ATZ OKN	part-time employment prior to retirement in the jurisdiction OKN
STATUS_2 or STATUS_3	BRF	vocational training
	BMP	miner's compensation payment
	VRS	receipt of early retirement benefit
	ALG	unemployment allowance/ALG I
	AUF	incapacity to work/illness
	ARM	military and civilian service
	PFL	unpaid care
	FWB	voluntary additional contributions
	SCH	school education
	SON	other pension-relevant events
	PMU	compulsory contributions for maternity leave (07/01/1979 - 12/31/1983)
	USV	supported employment
	RTB	pension payment
	HRT	back payment for marriage reimbursement
	FRG	Contributions according to the Foreign Pensions Law, split into: FRG BRF – vocational training FRG ARM – military service FRG BSH – gainful employment
	FZR	voluntary additional insurance in the GDR (FZR)
	NJB	side job
	AZ0	credit period - no pension paid
	AZ1	credit period - pension paid
	ALH	unemployment benefit/ALG II
STATUS_4	GF0	marginal employment without insurance contributions
STATUS_5	GF1	marginal employment with insurance contributions

2. Special characteristics of the data

Dynamic pension law Social law in general and pension law in particular have been continuously reformed in recent decades. For this reason, the receipt of earning points for reduced earnings capacity or old-age pension may vary in the amount for comparable statuses. "Credit periods" are subject to even greater

changes for comparable events such as unemployment. This means that values for different periods are not necessarily comparable with one another. This is explained in the following using the example of credit periods for school education (SCH). For school education, a maximum of 8 years (or 96 calendar months) is recorded as credit periods pursuant to section 58 (1) 1 No. 4 of the German Social Code Volume VI (*Sozialgesetzbuch VI, SGB VI*) since January 1st, 2002 (German Retirement Assets Extension Act (*Altersvermögensergänzungsgesetz*)). However, this maximum duration of credit periods for school education varied significantly to the extent that the duration of school education is not comparable across credit periods. For example, the maximum duration of credit periods in the period from January 1st, 1992 to December 31st, 1996 was just 7 years (German Pension Reform Act (*Rentenreformgesetz*)) and in the period from January 1st, 1997 to December 31st, 2001 it was a maximum of 36 calendar months (German Growth and Employment Promotion Act (*Wachstums- und Beschäftigungsförderungsgesetz*)). Moreover, as of January 1st, 2009, the credit periods for school periods no longer have an effect on the pension amount, while they were previously assessed with up to 0.75 earning points per year. This does not concern the periods of technical college education, which still have a pension-increasing effect. The German Act on Securing the Sustainable Financing of the Statutory Pension Insurance (*Gesetz zur Sicherung der nachhaltigen Finanzierungsgrundlagen der gesetzlichen Rentenversicherung*) (Bundesgesetzblatt 2004) gradually reduced this assessment in the years 2005 to 2008. Furthermore, recording of the credit periods previously commenced upon the age of 16. However, this was raised to the age of 17 with the German Growth and Employment Promotion Act of 1996.

The recording and assessment of various pension-relevant circumstances therefore vary significantly. It is thus advisable to consider which pension law applied in the corresponding period when using the data. For this reason, we recommend that researchers read the supporting material at the end of this document, where we refer to helpful study texts of the German Pension Insurance on the various circumstances.

Earnings data

The recording of gross earnings from regular dependent employment subject to social insurance contributions has always been handled consistently by the statutory pension insurance⁷. Such periods are always counted as “contribution periods”, since a deduction is taken from the gross earnings for the pension insurance. The underlying gross earnings are recorded in the insurance account.

The amount of the registered earning points from employment is determined by the gross earnings (recorded in variable ZREG) in relation to the average earnings defined for the calendar year (MW_EG) in accordance with Annex 6 SGB VI:

⁷ It should be noted that from 1984, one-off payments and bonus payments were also included in the income subject to social insurance for the first time. Before 1984, this information (provided by the companies) was voluntary Steiner und Wagner (1996): Has earnings inequality in Germany changed in the 1980's? ZEW Discussion Papers Nr. 96-32..

For employment subject to compulsory contributions (WSB, WKN) and self-employment (WSS) in western Germany, this results in the following calculation:

$$\text{STATUS_1_EGPT} = \text{STATUS_1_ZREG} / \text{MW_EG}$$

Here, exceptions apply to the eastern federal states. Gross earnings from the eastern federal states are first multiplied by the factors from Annex 10 (Annex 10 SGB VI, values for the conversion of the basis of assessment) and then considered in relation to the average income to determine the earning points.

The following applies to OSB, OKN and OSS (as well as for GDR periods):

$$\text{STATUS_1_EGPT} = \text{ANLAGE_10} * \text{STATUS_1_ZREG} / \text{MW_EG}$$

Due to this type of calculation, ZREG and EGPT only match in the eastern federal states by adding the values from Annex 10 SGB VI (variable ANLAGE_10).

Inaccuracies may occur at the current margin if the bases for assessment in Annexes 6 and 10 SGB VI have only been provisionally defined (Annex 6: average earnings, Annex 10: conversion factors). This concerns the last two calendar years prior to data collection. The earning points for these two years are only provisionally defined.

It is also possible for earning points to be registered without period earnings. This indicates a voluntary contribution payment, for example, which was made without deduction from earnings, such as in the case of tradespeople (WSS).

Contribution assessment ceiling

All incomes recorded in the variable STATUS_1_ZREG are gross earnings. The obligation to pay contributions to pension insurance only exists up to an upper limit, known as the contribution assessment ceiling. For this reason, the earnings are only recorded up to this ceiling.

Gross earnings are reported by the employer for each employment activity, at least on an annual basis. This report is known as the DEÜV report (DEÜV from the German Data Collection and Transmission Regulation (*Datenerfassungs- und Übermittlungsverordnung*)). The contributions for social insurance are paid monthly. Contributions for the regular monthly earnings and additionally for special payments to employees must be reported and the corresponding amounts paid. As a result of the reports on special payments, earnings may be reported above one twelfth of the annual contribution assessment ceiling in individual months. However, this does not exceed the annual contribution assessment ceiling. Possible examples of this are the employment circumstances of artists for limited periods of time, in addition to special payments for regularly employed workers. Further information on the reporting procedure can be found in Petrikowski und Hillig (2021).

Currency of earnings

Table 1 Currency of earnings by period

	Employment in eastern German federal states	Employment in western German federal states
until 06/20/1948	Reichsmark	Reichsmark
until 07/1990	GDR mark	D mark
until 12/2001	D mark	D mark
from 01/2002	EUR	EUR

Fluctuations of the period earnings (ZREG) and earning points (EGPT) in the variable part

The ZREG and EGPT may fluctuate from month to month. This does not have to be attributable to fluctuating gross earnings and may be the result of the method used to apportion the earnings to the respective calendar months. The ZREG and EGPT are calculated for the variable part as follows. For employment in the period from January 1st, 2003 to March 17th, 2003, 0.2 earning points are credited to the insurance account. These earning points are divided by the calendar days of the period: $0.2 / 76 = 0.00263158$.⁸

The calculated average daily earning points are then multiplied by the calendar days of the respective month in employment subject to compulsory social insurance contributions. This results in 0.08157898 earning points for January 2003, 0.07368424 for February and 0.04473686 for March. Although the person was continuously employed in the months of January and February, the income in this presentation varies significantly in the calendar months of January and February. In many cases, this does not correspond with empirical reality, as equal monthly earnings are typical in Germany.

Children's credit periods (KBZ), child-raising periods (KEZ)

Children's credit periods (KBZ) and child-raising periods (KEZ) are only shown in the fixed part.

The children's credit periods and child-raising periods assigned to a respective parent for the period are determined by the date of birth of the respective child, together with a duration defined by law. The social benefits in old-age provision for child-raising can be calculated based on the presented data as a supplement. Information on the topic of credit periods can be found, for example, in Begert (2021).

Side jobs (NJB)

The variable for side jobs (NJB) is only found in the variable part. It is the sum of all employment activities subject to social insurance contributions and self-employment, which occurred at the same time as the main employment activity (the employment activity with the highest earning points per calendar day) – regardless of their jurisdiction (*Rechtskreis*). Focus lies on the earning history here – and hence on the simultaneity of events – and not on the most precise representation possible of pension-relevant circumstances. This is different in the fixed part. Here, all employment activities – including parallel employment activities subject to social insurance contributions and self-employment – are added to the sum variables of the respective jurisdiction or the respective type of employment (WSB, WKN, OSB, OKN, WSS, OSS).

⁸ These "calendar day" earning points are also used for prioritisation based on the earning points in STATUS_2 and STATUS_3.

Therefore, deviations may arise when reconciling the sums from STATUS_1 in the variable part with the corresponding values in the fixed part, that are attributable to the existence of parallel employment activities. Figure 1 shows the notional history of a western German person, who had a side job (NJB) in February and March 2003 in addition to gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions, WSB). The side job becomes the main employment activity from April 2003 and therefore moves into STATUS_1.

The variable WSB_EGPTTAGE in the fixed part contains the sum of all days entered with EGPT recorded in the biographic history that relate to employment in western Germany subject to social insurance contributions. WSS_EGPTTAGE contains the corresponding sum from self-employment recorded in the pension account in western Germany.

Monthly data in the **variable part**

JAHR	MONAT	TAGE	STATUS_1	STATUS_1_TAGE	STATUS_1_EGPT	STATUS_2	STATUS_2_TAGE	STATUS_2_EGPT
2003	January	31	WSB	31	0,110			
2003	February	28	WSB	28	0,099	NJB	28	0,024
2003	March	31	WSB	14	0,050	NJB	31	0,027
2003	April	30	WSS	30	0,026			

Cumulated Values in the **fix part**

WSB_EGPTTAGE	73
WSB	0,259
WSS_EGPTTAGE	89
WSS	0,077

Figure 1 Example of the transfer of periods and earning points from the variable part to the fixed part

Employment periods in the GDR

Employment periods in the GDR are likewise recorded in the data and assessed with earning points. These are only traceable to actual wage amounts to a limited extent, since the contribution assessment ceiling in the GDR did not adequately follow the paid wages. For this reason, most workers reached and exceeded this threshold. This phenomenon repeated with the voluntary additional insurance (FZR), which was offered for old-age provision in the social insurance system of the GDR. This was likewise based on earnings but was not subject to dynamic adjustment in the maximum contribution amount according to the rising wages. As a result, the wages of most workers in the late 1980s also exceeded this contribution assessment limit. Consequently, distribution analyses on wage amounts can be conducted with the register data of the German pension insurance scheme only to a limited extent, as the contribution assessment ceilings cause substantial period effects.

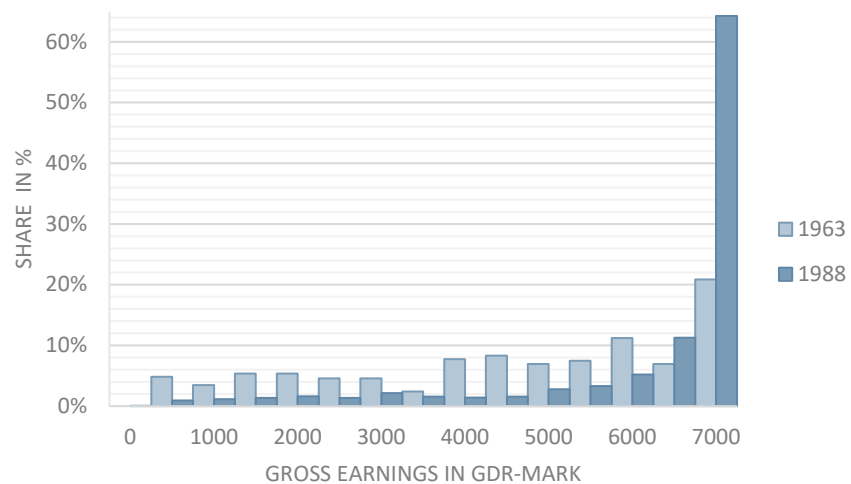


Figure 2 GDR income distribution in 1963 and 1988 in comparison

Figure 2 illustrates the phenomenon of gross earnings recorded in the GDR (without FZR income components) for the years 1963 and 1988. Further information on the special characteristics of the insurance periods in the GDR can also be found in Petrikowski und Hillig (2021) as well as Mattern und Bozidarevic (2021). Moreover, these periods were marked separately in the variable part and the months labelled with the “DDR” prefix (German for GDR) in STATUS_1.

Periods according to the German Foreign Pensions Act

The periods according to the Law on Foreign Pensions (*Fremdrentengesetz*, FRG) are also included in the variables of STATUS_2 and STATUS_3. Although this does refer to employment periods in the conventional sense, these periods were not included in STATUS_1 but instead assigned to the variables of STATUS_2 and STATUS_3. This is because the FRG periods were assessed based on a law that has been revised significantly on multiple occasions. Period effects can therefore have an impact on data quality. Generally, the earning points and period earnings from these employment periods do not correspond to the actual incomes in the country of origin, but to a reassessment following migration into the Federal Republic of Germany according to statutory assessment bases. The practiced occupations in the country of employment were categorized according to the classifications of Annex 13 SGB VI for the crediting of employment periods under the German Foreign Pensions Act. The equivalent incomes in Germany were then entered in the pension insurance account for these occupations based on Annex 14 SGB VI. Earning points were calculated in the following based on these notional period earnings. Depending on the date of immigration, these earning points are devalued again in subsequent calculation steps. Further information on the German Foreign Pensions Act can be found in Hunold (2021).

Back payments for school education

Periods of school education (school, university of applied sciences and university) are found in the block of STATUS_2 and STATUS_3. These periods are both credit periods and contribution periods due to back payments for school education. Although back payments are often made much later in life

than when the school education actually took place, the back payments are assigned to the periods in the pension account in which the education actually took place and not at the time when the back payment was made. The back payments for school education are therefore a valuable addition and have been integrated with the respective credit periods (SCH).

Back payment for marriage reimbursement

A back payment for a paid marriage reimbursement (sections 282 and 283 SGB VI) was possible until December 31st, 1995. Women insured in the employee insurance scheme, whose date of marriage lay after December 31st, 1956 and prior to January 1st, 1968, could have their pension insurance contributions as of the date of marriage reimbursed upon request. As a result of a legal change, contributions in an amount they chose could be paid back in at a later date. The women were credited earning points for the back payment for the period of the beginning of their employment biography. According to the law, the periods that lay furthest in the past were replenished. For reference, see section 122 (3) SGB VI.

The subsequently paid contributions were assessed as contribution periods for employment. As a result of this procedure, relatively high earning points may arise for the subsequently paid periods. Moreover, only a portion of the possible back payment period could be documented, which is why the duration must be considered notional.

If no back payments were made for reimbursed contributions, the insurance accounts contain gaps at the beginning of the employment biographies, although contribution periods originally existed. For women born in earlier year groups, this can result in an underestimation of the entitlements obtained at the start of the employment biographies. Further information on back payments can be found in Preker (2021).

Gaps

Gaps may exist in the biographic data. These are periods for which the pension insurance scheme has not registered a relevant status under social insurance law in the account. The reasons for this could include the person obtaining civil servant status, relocation abroad or a change to an occupation registered under a professional chamber.⁹ Gaps also occur frequently in periods of self-employment.

Furthermore, the number of episodes in the variable part is limited to 450 per insured person in the statistical data based on which the scientific use file was prepared. Consequently, information may be missing in particular for changeable employment histories towards the end of the observed period. This affects 38 respondents of the current sample.

Account clarification

The German pension insurance scheme maintains a personal account for each person from when an occupation is first reported to the social insurance scheme. This account is reviewed for completeness and plausibility at regular intervals from the age of 29. The insured persons are requested in

⁹ Occupations registered under a professional chamber include lawyers and notaries, tax advisors, architects, pharmacists, auditors, doctors and veterinarians, psychotherapists and farmers.

writing to cooperate in the review of their insurance account. They are prompted to report errors in the registered data and submit any missing information. However, cooperation on the part of the account holder is voluntary. This means that some accounts may also remain unclarified. Accounts of persons domiciled abroad do not have to be clarified. Variable KTSD in the fixed part indicates the year in which the insurance account was clarified whether the account is being clarified or is not yet clarified. Generally, account clarification increases the quality of the register data. This is especially the case for account clarification with the cooperation of the account holder. In particular, characteristics that are not reported to the pension insurance scheme via an automatic reporting procedure are less reliable in unclarified accounts.

Compulsorily insured self-employed persons	Periods of self-employment are not generally covered in the statutory pension insurance scheme. However, some occupation groups are subject to the pension insurance obligation. Artists, publicists, midwives, freelance teachers, marine pilots and coastal skippers are obligated to pay social insurance contributions for the entire duration of employment in these occupations. Tradespeople are obligated to pay pension insurance contributions in the first 18 years of their self-employment. The periods of compulsorily insured self-employment can be recognized via dedicated status values in the data. The reported earnings subject to insurance contributions do not necessarily reflect the actually earned incomes from self-employment. On the one hand, there are reduced rates at the start of self-employment. On the other hand, higher contributions may also be paid than is necessary according to the contribution rate. Finally, the income tax return forms the basis for the calculation of the contributions. Further information on the obligation to pay insurance on the part of self-employed persons can be found in Hermanns und Konrad (2021).
Marginal employment	The data format of the insurance account sample (Versichertenkontenstichprobe) does not permit any additional distinction according to employment in the private household or company. Moreover, marginal employment was only recorded as of 1999 and therefore documentation of the variable is still currently low. Earning points in the amount of “null” may be registered in STATUS_5_EGPT. This case always applies if the period earnings were so low or the employment period so short that the earning points could not be presented in the data format. Further information on the recording of marginal employment can be found in Petrikowski und Hillig (2021).
Pension rights adjustment	The pension rights adjustment is (not mandatorily) carried out in the event of divorce and divides the pension entitlements acquired during the divorced marriage to both ex-partners. The ex-partner who personally acquired fewer entitlements during the marriage receives a supplement in the pension rights adjustment. A deduction means that earning points were transferred to the other ex-partner during the pension rights adjustment. The data of the VSKT or the pension rights adjustment statistics (VA) include

information on divorces of those individuals who have gotten divorced since 1977 and whose pension entitlements were divided after divorce. Further information on the topic of pension rights adjustment can be found in Hentschke (2021).

Periods of incapacity to work (AUF)

Incapacity to work due to illness is determined according to the law of statutory health insurance. Accordingly, anyone who is unable to practice their most recent occupation due to their health condition is considered incapacitated for work. Incapacity to work (AUF) is deemed to exist if the insured person has received sickness benefit (Begert 2021).

AUF periods also encompass benefits for rehabilitation measures.

Importantly, the AUF periods are only comparable between men and women to a limited extent, as they also contain periods with child sickness benefits. These are typically recorded in the account of the mother due to differences in use. However, the data does not reveal whether the respective case concerns the incapacity to work of the insured person or the receipt of child sickness benefit.

An overview of compulsory contribution periods and credit periods for AUF periods is available in Begert (2021).

Part-time employment prior to retirement (Altersteilzeitarbeit)

In the variable section in STATUS_1, we show the months with part-time employment prior to retirement. Part-time employment prior to retirement exists, for example, if employees have reached the age of 55 and have reduced their working hours to half of their previous weekly working hours on the basis of an agreement with their employer (equal distribution model). Alternatively, the employee can work full-time in the first half of the part-time employment agreement period and is released from work in the second half (block model).¹⁰

AZ0 and AZ1

AZ0 and AZ1 periods show the transition to a reduced earnings capacity pension.

The AZ0 period shows the phase in which the event that later led to the reduced earnings capacity pension occurred.

The AZ1 period in turn shows the period in which the reduced earnings capacity pension was paid.

RTMOAG, RTMOZB and EUHORE

The variable RTMOAG originates from the SUEGPT (sum of earning points) and is adjusted for the supplementary periods. RTMOAG therefore ideally contains all pensionable earning points as of 31 December of the reporting year. The earning points in RTMOAG were then converted into euro values and stored in the variable RTMOZB. The pension values on 1 July of the reporting year plus 1 serve as the basis here. In the SOEP-RV.VSKT.2022 data

¹⁰ Further information can be found on the German Pension Insurance homepage: <https://www.deutsche-rentenversicherung.de/DRV/DE/Experten/Arbeitgeber-und-Steuerberater/summa-summarum/Lexikon/A/altersteilzeitarbeit.html>

set, the reporting year is 2022, so the pension values of 1 July 2023 apply here (€ 37.6).

RTMOZB and EUHORE together provide an estimate of how high the gross pension of the standard old-age pension could be.

Pension information simulation

Using the EUHORE variable, we forecast the expected pension entitlements from January 1st of the year following the reporting year (in this case: 2023) until the ordinary pensionable age. The calculation is based on the pension information sent by the German pension insurance scheme every year. The calculation assumes that contributions corresponding to the average of the last five calendar years continue to be paid until the beginning of regular old-age pension. Here, the reference date is December 31st of the reporting year.

The value is only calculated for persons who:

- a) have not yet exceeded ordinary pensionable age;
- b) meet the general waiting period of five years for regular old-age pension;
- c) have relevant contribution periods in the last five years.

The calculation is conducted separately for the four jurisdictions. The projections for the four jurisdictions are cumulated. The following contribution periods of the last five years are taken into account:

- Compulsory contribution for employment at a workshop for persons with disabilities pursuant to section 162 (2) and (2a) SGB VI
- Supported employment
- Compulsory contribution for the receipt of unemployment benefit
- Compulsory contribution for marginal employment without exemption from the insurance obligation or respectively with an increase of funds
- Compulsory contribution periods for care
- Compulsory contribution periods of the EU in the acceding territory pursuant to section 248 (2) SGB VI
- Part-time employment prior to retirement pursuant to the German Partial Retirement Act (*Altersteilzeitgesetz*, ATG) (from 01/01/1989); part-time work prior to retirement (from 08/01/1996)
- Compulsory contribution for employment subject to social security contributions
- Compulsory contribution for periods of maternity leave (07/01/1979-12/31/1983)
- Compulsory contribution pursuant to the German Rehabilitation Harmonisation Act (*Reha-Angleichungsgesetz*) (1974-1983) / compulsory contribution periods (1984-1991)
- Compulsory contribution for unemployment (1978-1982) / compulsory contribution for benefits from the Federal Employment Agency (*Bundesagentur für Arbeit*, BA) (from 1992) (not BYAT 04)
- Compulsory contribution for periods of military or civilian service
- Compulsory contribution for subsequent insurance (real)
- Compulsory contribution for subsequent insurance (notional)

- Compulsory contribution for self-employed persons
- Compulsory contribution for the receipt of early retirement benefit (from 01/05/1984) or pursuant to the German Act on the Promotion of the Cessation of Farming Employment (*Förderung der Einstellung der landwirtschaftlichen Erwerbstätigkeiten-Gesetz*, FELEG)

Calculation formula:

EUHORE = remaining days until ordinary pensionable age * daily EGPT in the period 01/01/(reporting year - 4) as of 12/31/ (reporting year) * pension value as at July 1st (reporting year + 1)

Sociodemographic information in SOEP and RV data

Method checks have shown that the correspondence of important sociodemographic characteristics such as age, gender, residence and nationality between SOEP and RV data is almost perfect. In order to avoid redundancies, the SOEP-RV data contains only few sociodemographic variables.

Observable differences exist in the number of children and in divorces. This is due to the logic of the administrative data of the pension insurance scheme. Since there is no structured and automatic reporting procedure for births (unlike employment subject to social insurance contributions, for example), births may be recorded twice (report by the mother and by the hospital). Furthermore, incorrectly spelled names may result in duplicate entries. Accordingly, “twin births” in particular should be treated with care for unclarified accounts.

Another phenomenon is that numbers of children for men only match for a very low share. This is because child-raising periods are typically credited to the insurance account of the mother, which is why the birth is only recorded in the account of the mother and not the father’s.

In the case of divorces, it is important to note that these are only recorded in the account of the pension insurance scheme if a pension rights adjustment took place between the ex-partners. It is therefore possible that the SOEP data contains more divorces than the FDZ-RV data.

3. Information on data management

3.1. Weighting

The SOEP data are equipped with frequency weights to do inference on the base population. In the linked data, these weights may be unsuited because of selectivity. Indeed, there are two potential sources of selectivity. First, not all respondents have been asked for consent. Second, of those who were asked for consent, not all consented. To adjust for this potential double selectivity, we suggest adjusting the SOEP weights by means of a four-step procedure:

Step 1: Estimate a logistic regression model for the SOEP respondents who are relevant for the intended research question, where the dependent variable is a dummy variable indicating whether respondents were asked for consent to the linkage (dummy is equal to one) or were not asked (dummy

is zero).¹¹ The independent variables should include all the variables that are relevant to the specific research question.

Step 2: Re-estimate the model of Step 1 only including the significant regressors and estimate the probability of being asked for linkage. Correct the SOEP weights multiplying them by the inverse of the estimated probability.

Step 3: For those being asked for consent, estimate a logistic regression model, where the dependent variable is a dummy variable indicating whether respondents consented to the linkage (dummy is equal to one) or did not consent (dummy is zero). The independent variables should include all the variables that are relevant for the specific research question, dummies for the year when consent was asked, a dummy indicating whether consent was asked twice.

Step 4: Re-estimate the model of Step 3 only including the significant regressors and estimate the probability of consenting to linkage. Correct the adjusted SOEP weights resulting from Step 2 by multiplying them by the inverse of the estimated probability.

3.2. Match with SOEP Data

Both the SOEP-RV data and the SOEP datasets “ppath” and “ppathl” contain the unique, case-related identification number “rv_id”, which serves to link the data from SOEP to the data from the pension insurance scheme. Further SOEP datasets can be referenced using the variable “pid” likewise contained in “ppath” and “ppathl”.

When referencing the pension insurance (RV) data to the SOEP, it is advisable to begin with the dataset “ppath” or “ppathl”, retain the cases with `rv_id > 0` and then to match the pension insurance data via the variable “rv_id”.

When matching the SOEP data to the pension insurance data, it is important to note that SOEP-RV.VSKT and SOEP-RV.RTBN contain persons from the SOEP CORE and the SOEP IS. To match information from the SOEP to all cases of the RV data, the ppath(l) dataset of both SOEP samples must be matched. The SOEP_IS variable in the fixed part of SOEP-RV.VSKT indicates whether the person is part of the innovation sample (SOEP_IS=1) or the SOEP CORE (SOEP_IS=0). Moreover, the “netto” variable from the “ppathl” dataset shows whether interviews in the SOEP were actually realized and therefore whether SOEP information is available. The values `netto >= 10` & `netto < 20` are used for this purpose.

When matching the SOEP and RV data, no assignment occurs for some cases although an `rv_id` is available. On the one hand, this is because of the 18,871 respondents who consent to linking, only 17,647 people could be assigned to a pension insurance account.¹² Of which, information could be reported from the pension insurance account for 16,648 people. The difference arises because no data can be reported if an account is being processed due to a rehabilitation or pension request, for example. These cases will be surveyed again for the next wave and then added to the dataset. Another four cases were removed from the reported cases, as no values existed (yet) for them in the variable part.

¹¹ The information whether a respondent has been asked for consent and whether the respondent consented to match RV- and SOEP-data can be found in variable “reclin_drv_erg” from the “pbrutto”-dataset.

¹² Information on 1,617 of these 18,871 respondents was available after the linkage with the pension insurance account had already been made. They will be added in the next wave of the data.

61 cases were removed because their information on gender and birthyear did not match the information in the SOEP. In sum the data contains 14,179 observations in the SOEP-CORE sample and 2,404 observations in the SOEP-IS sample.

3.3. Reshape

The variable part comes in the “long long” format and can be transformed into the formats “long wide” and “wide wide” with the following commands (STATA). However, for the “wide wide” format, space is required for more than 20,000 variables.

set maxvar 25000

- From “long long” to “long wide”:

```
reshape wide TAGE MW_EG BMG* ANLAGE_10 STATUS_*, i( rv_id JAHR ) j( MONAT )
```

- From “long wide” to “wide wide”:

```
reshape wide TAGE* MW_EG* BMG* ANLAGE_10* STATUS_*, i( rv_id ) j( JAHR )
```

4. Tabular code plan of the fixed part

4.1. Data-technical and sociodemographic parameters

Variable	Explanation
rv_id	Person identifier (fix across modules and waves) The unique case-related identification number contained in the SOEP datasets "ppath" and "ppathl" can be used to match the data from SOEP with the pension insurance data. Further SOEP datasets can be matched using the variable "pid", which is also included in "ppath" and "ppathl".
SOEP_IS	Flag-variable SOEP sample 0 = SOEP-CORE 1 = SOEP-IS
GEVS	Gender 1 = male 2 = female
GBJAVS	Year of birth Numeric variable in the form YYYY
TDJA	Year of death Numeric variable in the form YYYY 0 = person is not deceased
KTSD	Year of account clarification The year in the form YYYY in which account clarification was conducted. See page 9 of this documentation for further information on the account clarification process. 0 = no account clarification so far 9999 = account clarification in progress/ request for account clarification or the granting of a pension is still in progress

Variable	Explanation
LEAT	Payment type 1 = pensions for reduced earnings capacity 2 = old-age pension for unemployment 3 = old-age pension for part-time employment prior to retirement 4 = old-age pension for women 5 = old-age pension for severely disabled people 6 = old-age pension for long-term policy holders 7 = old-age pension for particularly long-term policy holders 8 = old-age pension 88 = other pension payments 99 = no pension payment
TLRT	Partial pension identifier 0 = no partial pension/ pension in the full amount 1 = partial pension/ pension not in the full amount
ZTPTRTBEJ	Year of the current pension Numeric variable in the form YYYY 0 = no pension payment
ZTPTRTBEM	Month of the current pension Numeric variable in the form MM 0 = no pension payment
GBKIIX	Year of birth of the nth child Numeric variable in the form YYYY 0 = no nth child
GBKIMX	Month of birth of the nth child Numeric variable in the form MM 0 = no nth child

4.2. Parameters from the pension calculation

Variable	Explanation
RCAT	Legal application of Law on Foreign Pensions (FRG) Which law was applicable is stated for cases with FRG periods. 0 = no FRG period recorded 6 = no application of sections 256 (b) and 259 (a) SGB VI and application of section 22 (1) FRG 10 = application of section 259 (a) SGB VI and no application of FRG 15 = application of section 259 (a) SGB VI and application of Article 6 (5) FANG 20 = application of section 256 (b) SGB VI and no application of FRG
OEGPT	Earning points (EGPT) (east) for Law on Foreign Pensions (FRG) The characteristic indicates for cases with FRG periods what type of earning points was taken into account. 0 = no FRG periods or respectively RCAT = 0 or RCAT = 20 1 = EGPT west without 0.7 reduction 2 = EGPT west with 0.7 reduction 5 = EGPT west with 0.6 reduction 6 = EGPT east with 0.6 reduction
OPXAZ	Share of earning points (EGPT) in East Germany The ratio (rounded to three decimal places) of earning points (east) to all the earning points of the (authoritative) overall assessment (section 263a SGB VI).
SUEGPT_WEST	Sum of earning points (incl. credit periods) – west The sum of all earning points (for the jurisdiction: general pension insurance and miner's pension insurance - WEST) from • contribution periods • non-contributory periods • supplements for reduced contribution periods • supplementary benefit • supplements of earning points for salaries from marginal employment exempt from insurance pursuant to § 76b, 264b SGB VI • supplements or deductions from pension rights adjustment • compensation for reduced pension • earning points for salaries from credit balances not used in accordance with an agreement on flexible working time regulations (which are already covered in contribution periods) • supplements and/or deductions from pension splitting • supplements for soldiers with extended insurance cover

Variable	Explanation
SUEGPT_OST	Sum of earning points (incl. credit periods) – east See SUEGPT_WEST
VAZU_WEST	Supplement from pension rights adjustment – west See page 10 of this documentation for further information on the pension rights adjustment in case of a divorce. The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places. 30 = 30 and more
VAZU_OST	Supplement from pension rights adjustment – east See page 10 of this documentation for further information on the pension rights adjustment in case of a divorce. The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places. 30 = 30 and more
VAAB_WEST	Deduction from pension rights adjustment – west See page 10 of this documentation for further information on the pension rights adjustment in case of a divorce. The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places. 30 = 30 and more
VAAB_OST	Deduction from pension rights adjustment – east See page 10 of this documentation for further information on the pension rights adjustment in case of a divorce. The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places. 30 = 30 and more
MIEGPTZQ_WEST	Additional minimum earning points for low salaries – west For pensions calculated in accordance with the provisions of SGB VI, the additional earning points (rounded to three decimal places) according to section 262 (1) (2) of SGB VI are indicated. The appreciation of the earning points according to this regulation ended in 1992. The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places.
MIEGPTZQ_OST	Additional minimum earning points for low salaries – east See MIEGPTZQ_WEST for further information. The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places.

4.3. Sums from the biographical history characteristics as at 12/31/2022

An overview of how the individual social situations were formed from the statistical data of the insurance account sample can be found in Table 2 in the Appendix.

Variable	Explanation
WSB_TAGE	Cumulated days of gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – west
WSB_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – west
WSB	Earning points (EGPT) for gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – west The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
WKN_TAGE	Cumulated days of miner's employment – west
WKN_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for miner's employment – west
WKN	Earning points (EGPT) for miner's employment – west The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
OSB_TAGE	Cumulated days of gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – east
OSB_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – east
OSB	Earning points (EGPT) for gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – east The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
OKN_TAGE	Cumulated days of miner's employment – east
OKN_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for miner's employment – east
OKN	Earning points (EGPT) for miner's employment – east The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
ATZ_WSB_TAGE	Cumulated days of gainful part-time employment prior to retirement – west

Variable	Explanation
ATZ_WSB_EGPT-TAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for gainful part-time employment prior to retirement – west
ATZ_WSB	Earning points (EGPT) for gainful part-time employment prior to retirement – west The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
ATZ_OSB_TAGE	Cumulated days of gainful part-time employment prior to retirement – east
ATZ_OSB_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for gainful part-time employment prior to retirement – east
ATZ_OSB	Earning points (EGPT) for gainful part-time employment prior to retirement – east The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
ATZ_OKN_TAGE	Cumulated days of miner's part-time employment prior to retirement – east
ATZ_OKN_EGPT-TAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for miner's part-time employment prior to retirement – east
ATZ_OKN	Earning points (EGPT) for miner's part-time employment prior to retirement – east The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
WSS_TAGE	Cumulated days of compulsory self-employment contribution – west
WSS_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for compulsory self-employment contribution – west
WSS	Earning points (EGPT) for compulsory self-employment contribution – west The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
OSS_TAGE	Cumulated days of compulsory self-employment contribution – east
OSS_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for compulsory self-employment contribution – east
OSS	Earning points (EGPT) for compulsory self-employment contribution – east The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
BRF_TAGE	Cumulated days of vocational training

Variable	Explanation
BRF_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for vocational training
BRF	Earning points (EGPT) for vocational training The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
BMP_TAGE	Cumulated days of miner's compensation payment
BMP_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for miner's compensation payment
BMP	Earning points (EGPT) for miner's compensation payment The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
VRS_TAGE	Cumulated days of early retirement benefit
VRS_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for early retirement benefit
VRS	Earning points (EGPT) for early retirement benefit The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
ALG_TAGE	Cumulated days of unemployment allowance/ALG I
ALG_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for unemployment allowance/ALG I
ALG	Earning points (EGPT) for unemployment allowance/ALG I The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
AUF_TAGE	Cumulated days of incapacity to work/illness Further information on the topic of incapacity to work can be found on page 11 of this document.
AUF_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days credited earning points (EGPT>0) for incapacity to work/illness
AUF	Earning points (EGPT) for incapacity to work/illness The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
ARM_TAGE	Cumulated days of military and civilian service
ARM_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for military and civilian service

Variable	Explanation
ARM	Earning points (EGPT) for military and civilian service The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
PFL_TAGE	Cumulated days of unpaid care
PFL_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for unpaid care
PFL	Earning points (EGPT) for unpaid care The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
FWB_TAGE	Cumulated days of voluntary additional contributions
FWB_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for voluntary additional contributions
FWB	Earning points (EGPT) for voluntary additional contributions The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
SCH_TAGE	Cumulated days of school education Further information on the topic of school education can be found on page 8 of this document.
SCH_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for school education
SCH	Earning points (EGPT) for school education The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
SON_TAGE	Cumulated days of other pension-relevant events
SON_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for other pension-relevant events
SON	Earning points (EGPT) for other pension-relevant events The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
PMU_TAGE	Cumulated days of compulsory contributions for maternity leave (07/01/79 - 12/31/83)
PMU_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for compulsory contributions for maternity leave (07/01/79 - 12/31/83)
PMU	Earning points (EGPT) for compulsory contributions for maternity leave (07/01/79 - 12/31/83)

Variable	Explanation
USV_TAGE	Cumulated days of supported employment
USV_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for supported employment
USV	Earning points (EGPT) for supported employment The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
RTB_TAGE	Cumulated days of pension payment Only days are shown for the receipt of pension benefits, as no earning points can be credited for them in the account.
HRT_TAGE	Cumulated days of back payment for marriage reimbursement This parameter indicates whether a back payment is recorded in the insurance account for marriage reimbursement (sections 282 and 283 of SGB VI). Further information on back payments for marriage reimbursement can be found on page 9 of this document.
HRT_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for back payment for marriage reimbursement
HRT	Earning points (EGPT) for back payment for marriage reimbursement The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
FRG_TAGE	Cumulated days of contributions according to the Law on Foreign Pensions (FRG) Further information on the topic of foreign pension periods can be found on page 8 of this document.
FRG_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for contributions according to the Law on Foreign Pensions (FRG)
FRG	Earning points (EGPT) for contributions according to the Law on Foreign Pensions (FRG) The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
FZR_TAGE	Cumulated days of voluntary additional insurance in the GDR (FZR)
FZR_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for voluntary additional insurance in the GDR (FZR)
FZR	Earning points (EGPT) for voluntary additional insurance in the GDR (FZR) The earning points are rounded to three decimal places

Variable	Explanation
AZ0_TAGE	Cumulated credit periods in days – no pension paid
AZ1_TAGE	Cumulated credit periods in days – pension paid
ALH_TAGE	Cumulated days of unemployment benefit/ALG II
ALH_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for unemployment benefit/ALG II
ALH	Earning points (EGPT) for unemployment benefit/ALG II The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
GFO_TAGE	Cumulated days of marginal employment without insurance contributions
GF1_TAGE	Cumulated days of marginal employment with insurance contributions Further information on the topic of marginal employment can be found on page 10 of this document.
GF1_EGPTTAGE	Cumulated days with credited earning points (EGPT>0) for marginal employment with insurance contributions
GF1	Earning points (EGPT) for marginal employment with insurance contributions The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
KEZ	Earning points (EGPT) for child-raising periods The earning points are rounded to three decimal places
KBZ	Earning points (EGPT) for child care periods The earning points are rounded to three decimal places. This variable indicates the additional/credited earning points for child-raising periods or periods of unpaid care for a child in need of care. This information comes from the ZQEGPTKIP variable in the underlying statistical data. In order to calculate the care periods for children in need of care, the earning points from the combination of BYAT 61 and BYATSO 2 in the statistical data were subtracted from ZQEGPTKIP. ¹³

¹³ BYAT and BYATSO explanations together with the legal basis, can be found, for example, in our codeplan for the VSKT (Datensatz SK 79 für die Versicherungskontenstichprobe (eng: data set SK 79 for the insurance account sample)) on our homepage <https://fdz-rv.de>

Variable	Explanation
EUHORE	Euro amount of the extrapolated EGPT for a regular old-age pension Forecast of pension information based on July 1 st (reporting year +1). Further information on the topic of pension information and details on the forecast calculation can be found on page 12 of this document.
RTMOAG	Sum of earning points (EGPT) from SUEGPT_WEST and SUEGPT_OST without credit periods Total earning points as of December 31 st of the reporting year, i.e. the credit periods which are included in the variables SUEGPT_WEST and SUEGPT_OST are explicitly excluded from the calculation. Credit periods are forward projections of the earning points until standard retirement age.
RTMOZB	Euro amount of earning points (EGPT) in RTMOAG Conversion of EGPT from RTMOAG using the pension values from July 1 st (reporting year + 1).

4.4. Parameters on divorce

Variable	Explanation
ANZ_SCHEIDUNG	Number of divorces Number of divorces recorded in the pension rights adjustment statistics (VA). The following variables contain detailed information for the first two marriages/divorces of an insured person. See page 10 of this documentation for further information on the pension rights adjustment in case of a divorce. 0 = no divorce 3 = three and more divorces
EB1_JAHR	Year of start – first marriage Numeric variable in the form YYYY -2 = does not apply (due to no divorce)
EB1_MONAT	Month of start – first marriage Numeric variable in the form MM -2 = does not apply (due to no divorce)
ES1_JAHR	Year of end – first marriage Numeric variable in the form YYYY -2 = does not apply (due to no divorce)

Variable	Explanation
ES1_MONAT	Month of end – first marriage Numeric variable in the form MM -2 = does not apply (due to no divorce)
DRK1_JAHR	Year of legal validity – first divorce Numeric variable in the form YYYY -2 = does not apply (due to no divorce)
DRK1_MONAT	Month of legal validity – first divorce Numeric variable in the form MM -2 = does not apply (due to no divorce)
VAZU_ES1	Supplement from pension rights adjustment – first divorce The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places. -2 = does not apply (due to no divorce) 30 = 30 and more
VAAB_ES1	Deduction from pension rights adjustment – first divorce The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places. -2 = does not apply (due to no divorce) 30 = 30 and more
EB2_JAHR	Year of start – second marriage Numeric variable in the form YYYY -2 = does not apply (due to no second divorce)
EB2_MONAT	Month of start – second marriage Numeric variable in the form MM -2 = does not apply (due to no second divorce)
ES2_JAHR	Year of end – second marriage Numeric variable in the form YYYY -2 = does not apply (due to no second divorce)
ES2_MONAT	Month of end – second marriage Numeric variable in the form MM -2 = does not apply (due to no second divorce)
DRK2_JAHR	Year of legal validity – second divorce Numeric variable in the form YYYY -2 = does not apply (due to no second divorce)
DRK2_MONAT	Month of legal validity – second divorce Numeric variable in the form MM -2 = does not apply (due to no second divorce)

Variable	Explanation
VAZU_ES2	Supplement from pension rights adjustment – second divorce The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places. -2 = does not apply (due to no second divorce) 30 = 30 and more
VAAB_ES2	Deduction from pension rights adjustment – second divorce The indicated earning points are rounded to three decimal places. -2 = does not apply (due to no second divorce) 30 = 30 and more

5. Tabular code plan of the variable part

Variable	Explanation
rv_id	Person identifier (fixed across modules and waves) The unique case-related identification number contained in the SOEP datasets "ppath" and "ppathl", which can be used to match the data from SOEP with the pension insurance data. Further SOEP datasets can be matched using the variable "pid", which is also included in "ppath" and "ppathl".
JAHR	Year
MONAT	Month
TAGE	Number of days in month (number of calendar days in the respective month)
MW_EG	Annex 1 SGB VI, average earnings in EUR/DM/RM in the respective year
BMG_WEST	Annex 2 SGB VI, contribution assessment ceiling in the respective year – west
BMGKN_WEST	Annex 2 SGB VI, miner's contribution assessment ceiling in the respective year – west
ANLAGE_10	Annex 10 SGB VI, conversion factors in the respective year
BMG_OST	Annex 2a SGB VI, contribution assessment ceiling in the respective year – east
BMGKN_OST	Annex 2a SGB VI, miner's contribution assessment ceiling in the respective year – east
TAGE_OST	Number of days in the month with recorded earning points – east
STATUS_1	Type of employment Nature/jurisdiction of the employment subject to social insurance contributions or self-employment WSB = gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – west WKN = miner's employment – west WSS = self-employment (obligated to pay social insurance) – west OSB = gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – east since 7/1990 OKN = miner's employment – east since 7/1990 OSS = self-employment (obligated to pay social insurance) – east DDR OSB = gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions) – east until 6/1990 DDR OKN = miner's employment – east until 6/1990

Variable	Explanation
	ATZ WSB = part-time employment prior to retirement (Altersteilzeit) is indicated in the jurisdiction WSB I ATZ OSB = part-time employment prior to retirement (Altersteilzeit) is indicated in the jurisdiction OSB ATZ OKN = part-time employment prior to retirement (Altersteilzeit) is indicated in the jurisdiction OKN
STATUS_1_TAGE	Number of days – status 1 Number of days recorded with compulsory contributions from employment subject to social insurance contributions or self-employment in the respective month.
STATUS_1_ZREG	Period earnings – status 1 Period gross earnings based on compulsory contributions from employment subject to social insurance contributions or self-employment in the respective month, rounded to integers. Attention: the currency may be stated in GDR marks, D marks or euros. Please note the information on currency on page 6 of this document.
STATUS_1_EGPT	Earning points – status 1 Earning points based on compulsory contributions in the respective month, rounded to three decimal places.
STATUS_2	Type of parallel status 2 Indicator for additionally recorded statuses. The following statuses were observed in this connection. In the event of parallel statuses, prioritization occurs based on the higher earning points. In the event of equal earning points, the statuses are prioritized according to the order entered. Further information on the respective statuses can be found in Table 2 in the Appendix. BRF = vocational training BMP = miner's compensation payment VRS = early retirement benefit ALG = unemployment allowance/ALG I AUF = incapacity to work/illness ARM = military and civilian service PFL = unpaid care FWB = voluntary additional contributions SCH = school education SON = other pension-relevant events PMU = compulsory contributions for maternity leave (07/01/79 - 12/31/83) USV = supported employment RTB = pension payment HRT = back payment for marriage reimbursement

Variable	Explanation
	FRG = contributions according to the Law on Foreign Pensions (FRG) FRG-contributions are split into: FRG BRF – vocational training FRG ARM – military service FRG BSH – gainful employment FZR = voluntary additional insurance in the GDR NJB = side job AZ0 = credit periods – no pension paid AZ1 = credit periods – pension paid ALH = unemployment benefit/ALG II
STATUS_2_TAGE	Number of days – status 2 Number of recorded days for status 2.
STATUS_2_EGPT	Earning points – status 2 Credited earning points for status 2 in the respective month, rounded to three decimal places.
STATUS_3	Type of parallel status 3 Indicator for additionally recorded statuses. Please note STATUS_2 and Table 2 in the Appendix for further information.
STATUS_3_TAGE	Number of days – status 3 Number of recorded days for status 3.
STATUS_3_EGPT	Earning points – status 3 Credited earning points for status 3 in the respective month, rounded to three decimal places.
STATUS_4_TAGE	Number of days – status 4 Number of recorded days with marginal employment without an insurance obligation. Because income from marginal employment has only been subject to social insurance contributions since April 1st, 1999, it is only recorded in the insurance accounts from this date. Marginal employment prior to the legal change is not recorded. Further information on the topic of marginal employment can be found on page 10 of this document.
STATUS_5_TAGE	Number of days – status 5 Number of recorded days with marginal employment with an insurance obligation.
STATUS_5_EGPT	Earning points – status 5

Variable	Explanation
	Credited earning points for marginal employment with an insurance obligation in the respective month, rounded to three decimal places.

6. Alphabetic list of variables

ALG	22	FRG	24	RTMOAG.....	26
ALG_EGPTTAGE	22	FRG_EGPTTAGE	24	RTMOZB.....	26
ALG_TAGE.....	22	FRG_TAGE.....	24	rv_id.....	16
ALH	25	FWB	23	SCH	23
ALH_EGPTTAGE	25	FWB_EGPTTAGE	23	SCH_EGPTTAGE	23
ALH_TAGE.....	25	FWB_TAGE.....	23	SCH_TAGE.....	23
ANLAGE_10.....	29	FZR.....	24	SON.....	23
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BMGKN_WEST.....	29	MW_EK.....	29	WKN_EGPTTAGE	20
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BMP_EGPTTAGE.....	22	OKN	20	WSB	20
BMP_TAGE.....	22	OKN_EGPTTAGE	20	WSB_EGPTTAGE	20
BRF.....	22	OKN_TAGE.....	20	WSB_TAGE	20
BRF_EGPTTAGE.....	22	OPXAZ.....	18	WSS.....	21
BRF_TAGE	21	OSB	20	WSS_EGPTTAGE	21
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7. Additional Literature

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8. Appendix

Table 2 Overview of all variables and their counterpart in the VSKT statistical data

Fixed and variable part

WSB, WKN, OSB, OKN, DDR, ATZ	gainful employment (subject to social insurance contributions)	BYAT 10 (excl. FRG) BYAT 9	BYATSO 0, 3, 4, 5, 8, 9	compulsory contribution compulsory contribution for part-time employment prior to retirement (Altersteilzeitbeschäftigung)
WSS, OSS	self-employment (obligated to pay social insurance)	BYAT 17		compulsory contribution for self-employed persons
BRF	vocational training	BYAT 10 (excl. FRG)	BYATSO 1, 2, 6, 7	compulsory contribution for vocational training
BMP	miner's compensation payment	BYAT 90		miner's compensation payment
VRS	compulsory contribution for early retirement benefit	BYAT 18		compulsory contribution due to early retirement benefit
ALG	compulsory contribution for unemployment benefit	BYAT 13		compulsory contribution for unemployment (1978 - 1982)
AUF	incapacity to work/illness	BYAT 12 BYAT 40, 41, 48	BYATSO 1, A	compulsory contribution according to the Rehabilitation Harmonisation Act credit periods rehabilitation
ARM	military and civilian service	BYAT 14 (excl. FRG)		compulsory contribution for military and civilian service
PFL	unpaid care	BYAT 7 BYAT 20, 21 BYAT 60	BYATSO 8 BYATSO 2	compulsory contribution periods for care voluntary contribution for care credit period for care
FWB	voluntary additional contributions	BYAT 20, 21	BYATSO 0, 2, 5, 6, 7	voluntary additional contributions
SCH	school education	BYAT 20, 21 BYAT 40, 41, 42, 43, 48	BYATSO 3 BYATSO 4, 6, 7, 8, C	back payment for school education credit periods for school and university (of applied sciences)

SON	other pension-relevant events	BYAT 30, 31 BYAT 40, 41, 48 BYAT 60 BYAT 20, 21 BYAT 15 BYAT 16 BYAT 26 BYAT 8 BYAT 49 BYAT 40, 41, 48	BYATSO 9 BYATSO 6, 7 BYATSO 1 BYATSO 2	substitute periods other credit periods credit period and self-employment voluntary additional insurance exceedance of annual earnings compulsory contribution for subsequent insurance (real) compulsory contribution for subsequent insurance (notional) data exchange for increase (notional) FZR compulsory contribution periods of the EU in the acceding territory pursuant to section 248 (2) SGB VI subsequent insurance not yet conducted due to missing application pregnancy compulsory contribution for maternity
PMU	compulsory contribution for maternity leave (07/01/79 -12/31/83)	BYAT 11		
USV	supported employment and workshop for persons with disabilities	BYAT 2 BYAT 3		compulsory contribution for workshop for persons with disabilities supported employment
RTB	pension payment	BYAT 70 BYAT 71 BYAT 72		pension drawn from own insurance or KN adjustment old-age pension drawn (full pension) old-age pension drawn (partial pension)
HRT	back payment for marriage reimbursement	BYAT 20, 21	BYATSO 4	back payment for marriage reimbursement
FRG	FRG period	Combination of RCEG, BHBR, QLGR & VSGR ¹⁴	SES_FRG != .	contributions according to the Law on Foreign Pensions (FRG)
FZR	voluntary additional insurance in the GDR	BYAT 25		FZR periods exclusively
AZ0	credit period – no pension paid (RTVS = 0)	BYAT 40, 41, 48	BYATSO 5	credit period – no pension paid
AZ1	credit period – pension paid (RTVS = 1)	BYAT 40, 41, 48	BYATSO 5	credit period – pension paid
ALH	periods with unemployment, unemployment benefit or ALG II	BYAT 4 BYAT 40, 41 48	BYATSO 3, B, D	compulsory contribution due to unemployment benefit drawn credit periods due to unemployment
GF0	marginal employment without insurance contributions	BYAT 5		without insurance contributions
GF1	marginal employment with insurance contributions	BYAT 6		with insurance contributions

Only in the fixed part

¹⁴ Further information is available on request by contacting fdz-rv-berlin@drv-bund.de

KEZ	child-raising period	BYAT 19		child-raising period
KBZ	child care period	ZQEGPTKIPE		credit period for raising children and/or caring for a child in need of care.
		BYAT 61	BYATSO 2	The difference between ZQEGPTKIPE and (BYAT 61, BYATSO 2) results in KBZ
Only in the variable part				
NJB	second job in the variable part	BYAT 10 (excl. FRG) BYAT 17	BYATSO 0, 3, 4, 5, 8, 9	in case of parallel employment (of WSB, WKN, WSS, OSB, OKN, OSS and DDR spells) job with the lower EGPT on a monthly basis